

Terrace

Machu Picchu was surrounded by steep cliffs. This meant that not much land was available to grow food, and farms had to be built into the hillside.

Most Inca people are farmers, craftsmen, or servants.

Stone walls absorbed the sun's heat in the day, which helped keep the plants warm at night.

The flat areas formed by the terrace provided space for different crops to be planted together—beans could climb up the stalks of maize, with squash growing underneath.

Farms

When viewed from above it is possible to see how the Inca dug steps into the hillside and built walls to keep the vertical parts upright. These slivers of flat land are known as terraces. Inca farmers used them to grow food including maize, which was also turned into *chicha*.

DIGGING THE SOIL



Inca farmers used a device called a *chakitaclla* to help them plant seeds. This was a long wooden stick that had a curving handle and foot rest tied to it. The *chakitaclla* made it easy for the farmers to dig holes in the earth using the pressure from their feet and their own body weight.

